



NILFHEIM

The souls of those who died dishonourably are sent to the underground kingdom of Niflheim – the World of Fog ruled by the gloomy goddess Hel. It was said that whole families would end up together after death, close to landmarks they knew in life, such as mountains or streams.

Hel, daughter of Loki, rules over the disgraced dead. Her face is downcast, her manner cold and uncaring.

THE AFTERLIFE

Life in the Viking Age was hard, and the threat of famine and disease was never far away. No Viking felt the chill of death quite so closely as a warrior risking his life at sea, on a raid or in battle. So it's no wonder that the question of what happened to a person's soul after death was of great importance to the Norse.

VALHALLA

The Hall of the Slain. This is where half the warriors who fall bravely in battle go (the others go to Freya). Valhalla is a magnificent banqueting hall with a roof made from shields, and rafters from spears. Wolves guard its 540 doors and eagles circle the roof.

Einherjar or the “army of one” dwell in Valhalla. These souls of the bravest Viking warriors feast, drink and make merry – but only until Ragnarök, when they must go forth and fight for Odin one last time.

Saehrimnir is a boar who is slaughtered and cooked in a giant cauldron and eaten by the Einherjar every single day, only to be brought back to life afterwards.